Helping verb or main verb?

Name: **Date:**

The word in CAPITALS is a form of **be**, **have** or **do**.
Tick **H** if it is a helping verb (there is another verb after it).
Tick **M** if it is the main verb (it is the only verb).

		H	M
	Maya HAS a red bicycle.	☐	☐
	Maya HAS ridden her bicycle to school.	☐	☐
	The soup IS too hot to eat.	☐	☐
1. 2.	The soup IS boiling on the stove.	☐	☐
3. 4.	We DID our homework at the library.	☐	☐
5. 6.	We DID finish our homework on time.	☐	☐
7. 8.	The dogs ARE hungry.	☐	☐
9. 10.	The dogs ARE waiting by their bowls.	☐	☐
11. 12.	I HAVE two tickets for the show.	☐	☐
	I HAVE seen that show before.	☐	☐
	They DO the dishes every evening.	☐	☐
	DO you play chess?	☐	☐

WRITE YOUR OWN

Write one sentence using "was" as the main verb and one using "was" as a helping verb.

1. was as the main verb:

_____

2. was as a helping verb:

_____

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Helping verb or main verb? - Answer key

1. M	2. H	3. M	4. H	5. M	6. H
7. M	8. H	9. M	10. H	11. M	12. H

WRITE YOUR OWN (sample answers):

1. The party was fun.

2. The band was playing all night.

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